Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Paige Turner

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Paige Turner

Investigative Arts Journalist

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Her journalistic integrity is unmatched. Paige covers the art world for the Times of Tulsa the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees to keep silent.

- Keeps asking **Barb Dwyer** for access to museum records. **Barb** keeps asking what the story is about.
- **Sue Venir** has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls **Reed DeLabel** to check dates and catalog references. **Reed** is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Paige Turner. I am covering the gala. I just want to say in advance that absolutely nothing is off the record tonight.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Paige Turner

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Cannot separate protecting a vulnerable source from her need to keep being the reporter who gets the story.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Paige Turner

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The house has its own cinema. Inspect the side the audience never sees.*

2 *A decorative vessel has traded its bouquet for evidence.*

3 *A green lamp cannot testify, but something near it can.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Paige Turner

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Paige Turner

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My article had an unsupported sentence. I owed a correction. Grant wanted the source behind the rest. Justin's property folder made his rescue story less flattering than the arts desk expected. I wanted the records with my editor before his announcement. He kept asking for a name. I keep hearing that question now. Somebody outside this room will be frightened when they learn he's dead.

IF MURDERER

My article had an unsupported sentence. Grant's lawyer used it against the rest. Grant wanted my source and offered to leave that person alone if I supplied a name. Justin's property folder made his rescue story less flattering. I wanted the records in print. He wanted somebody he could approach without me there. Somebody outside this room will be frightened when they learn he's dead.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Paige Turner

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> My recorder was in his coat at the cloakroom. He'd kept it after our interview. I searched the pocket and copied the file. The critic got a short export with the identifying part removed. My editor knew the cut and had the untrimmed file. Barb, I know I didn't have permission to search the coat. He didn't have permission to keep my recorder either.

IF MURDERER

> Grant kept my recorder in his coat. I searched the coat at the cloakroom and copied the file there. The critic got a short export; my editor kept the original. I stayed at the cloakroom to check it. I didn't take it to his private place or leave it beside a waiting drink. Barb, yes, I searched a pocket without permission. You can put that in your report.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Paige Turner

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Tonight, in his private room. The manager leaves his glass and goes back to the kitchen. I cut that voice from the critic's export; my editor kept the original. I won't name my source. Sue, ask me about my recording. Leave the person I was protecting out of it.

IF MURDERER

> There was no drink between us when I interviewed him. That was yesterday, in the office. Tonight I fetched the recorder from his coat and checked the export at the cloakroom, not at his private place. The cut employee's voice protected a source. My editor has the original. Ask for that.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Paige Turner

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Paige Turner

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The untrimmed opening places our interview at his private table tonight. My editor had that original; I cut the employee's voice from the export. The correction will run. The source's name won't. I also need to ask that person what they want now. I have spent too much of this investigation treating being protected and being useful to me as the same thing.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The interview was tonight at his private place, while the manager left his glass. The original opening proves it. After Grant returned to the reception I went back, alone, and used poison I'd taken at the preview. I called the interview yesterday's office conversation to make that recording unrelated to tonight. I wanted to protect my source; I chose murder instead. My editor has the original. Someone will have to tell the person who trusted me what I did with their trust.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.